

Ekam LMS

Platform Functionality & User Flows

A complete walkthrough of how students and instructors use the platform today, everything added in the most recent build, and how it all works under the hood.

What This Document Covers

- The full **student journey** — from anonymous browsing to purchasing, learning, testing, and earning badges.
- The full **instructor journey** — from sign-up to course creation, review, and going live.
- A short note on the **admin review** step that connects the two.
- Everything that was **newly added** in this build, grouped by feature.
- What was **already working** before this build, for context.
- Honest notes on how the platform is built today, and what upgrading to a real backend would unlock.

1. Student User Flow

1.1 Browsing — no account needed

Anyone landing on Ekam — logged in or not — can browse the full course catalog: every category, every course's title, description, curriculum outline (section and lesson names), instructor profile, rating, and price or subscription tag. Nothing is hidden behind a login wall at the browsing stage.

The one video anyone can actually watch without logging in or paying is the course's **Intro / Preview video**, which every instructor uploads at course-creation time. It plays publicly on the course detail page regardless of login or purchase state — this is intentional, so a visitor can judge a course before committing to it.

1.2 Signing up / logging in

A student creates an account with name, email and password (or uses one of the quick demo logins). The same email always maps back to the same account on future logins — this was fixed in this build (see Section 4).

1.3 Getting access to a course

Every course is one of two types, chosen by its instructor:

- **Paid course** — a one-time price set by the instructor. The student clicks **Buy Now** on the course page to unlock it.
- **Subscription course** — included in Ekam's flat monthly plan (Rs. 100/month). The student subscribes once on the **/subscription** page (or directly from a subscription course's page) and instantly gets access to every current and future subscription-tagged course.

Both actions are instant in the current build — there is no real payment gateway wired up yet (see Section 6). The moment a student purchases or subscribes, the course also appears in their **My Learning** list.

1.4 Working through a course — the lesson loop

Once a student has access, lessons are **not** all unlocked at once — they open strictly one at a time, in order. The loop for each lesson is:

1. **Watch the lesson video** to the end. The platform genuinely detects whether the video finished playing (via the YouTube player's own end-of-video signal, or the browser's native video-ended event for uploaded files) — simply opening and skipping away does not count.
2. Once the video ends, a **Take Test** button appears for that lesson's quiz — a set of multiple-choice questions the instructor wrote while creating the course.
3. Questions are shown **one at a time**. The student answers and moves to the next.
4. If **every** answer is correct, the lesson is marked complete, XP is awarded, and the **next lesson unlocks**.
5. If **any** answer is wrong, the student sees their score and must **rewatch the video and retake the test** — there is no partial credit and no way to skip ahead.

This repeats lesson by lesson until every lesson in the course has been watched and passed.

1.5 Finishing a course — badges, XP and levels

Two things happen automatically the moment the last lesson is passed:

- The student is awarded a **badge** named after the course's category and level — for example, completing a Beginner Hindustani Vocal course earns a "**Shastriya Sangeet Beginner**" badge. Enrolling later in an Advanced course in the same subject earns a separate "**Shastriya Sangeet Advanced**" badge. Badges collect in the student's Profile page.
- A completion bonus of XP is added on top of what was already earned from watching videos and passing tests along the way. A notification is also sent to the student's notification bell.

XP accumulates into **Levels**: Level 1 at 100 XP, Level 2 at 300 XP, Level 3 at 500 XP, and so on (each level needs 200 more XP than the last). The student's current level, XP progress bar, and full badge collection are all shown on their **Profile** page.

1.6 Where students see everything

My Learning	Every course the student has purchased or subscribed to, with a live progress bar and percentage complete for each.
Certificates	Automatically lists a certificate for every course the student has 100% completed.
Profile	Account details, current Level and XP bar, full badge collection, and quick links.
Leaderboard	Students ranked by Level, then by their highest badge tier (Advanced beats Intermediate beats Beginner), then by total badge count — resets weekly.
Wishlist	A simple heart-toggle on any course page to save it for later, independent of purchase.

2. Instructor User Flow

2.1 Becoming an instructor

A user signs up choosing the "Instructor" role (or an existing student account can be repurposed by logging in through the instructor path). This gives access to the **Instructor Dashboard**, with five sections: Overview, My Courses, Create Course, Earnings, and Students.

2.2 Creating a course — a 3-step form

Step 1 — Basic Info

- Title and description.
- Category — one of the eight existing traditions (Shastriya Sangeet, Nritya Kala, Yoga & Dhyan, Chitrakala, Sanskrit, Vedic Studies, Paaka Vidya, Hastkala) or **"Other"**, which reveals a free-text "please specify" field for anything not yet on the list.
- Level (Beginner / Intermediate / Advanced / All Levels / Beginner to Intermediate) and language.
- **Pricing Model** — a one-time paid price, or "Included in Subscription" (no individual price; unlocked for anyone with an active Ekam subscription).
- The course's public **Intro / Preview video** URL — the one video every visitor can watch for free.

Step 2 — Curriculum

- Optional study material setting: no PDF, one PDF for the whole course, or a separate PDF per lesson.
- Sections and lessons are built up freely — add as many sections and lessons as needed.
- For every lesson's video, and for every lesson's PDF (when per-lesson material is chosen), the instructor picks **either** "Upload" a file directly **or** "Paste URL" to link one already hosted elsewhere (e.g. a YouTube link).
- Directly under each lesson, an expandable **"Video N Test"** panel lets the instructor add as many multiple-choice questions as they like — each with 4 answer options and one marked correct. This is the test students must pass to unlock the next lesson.

Step 3 — Pricing & Submission

- If the course is paid, the instructor sets the price here (Ekam sets the commission % later, at approval time).
- If the course is a subscription course, this step simply confirms it has no individual price.
- A live preview of how the course card will look.
- A clear disclaimer: **once Ekam approves the course, it cannot be edited** — the instructor is prompted to double-check everything before submitting.
- "Submit for Review" sends the course to the admin queue with status **Pending**.

2.3 After submission

- **Approved** — the course goes live immediately with the commission percentage Ekam's team set for it. The instructor gets a notification stating the exact commission rate. The course now shows a lock icon instead of an edit button in **My Courses** — it can no longer be modified or deleted through editing.
- **Rejected** — the instructor is notified and can edit the course (still unlocked, since it never went live) and resubmit it for another review.

2.4 Earnings

The Earnings tab breaks down, per paid course: gross revenue, Ekam's commission (using the rate set at approval), and the instructor's net payout — plus platform-wide totals across all of the instructor's courses.

3. Admin Review — the link between the two

Admins see every pending course with its full description and a clickable preview of its intro video and every lesson's video/material — whether it was uploaded directly or linked via URL — before deciding.

- **Approve** — the admin sets a custom commission percentage for that specific course/instructor (not a fixed platform-wide number), which locks in immediately.
- **Reject** — sends the course back to the instructor with a notification, for edits and resubmission.

Admins also have an Overview (platform stats), an All Courses table, an Instructors directory, and a Revenue summary.

4. What Was Added in This Build

Everything below is new. Together it turns Ekam from a course catalog with an instant "enrol for free" button into an actual gated marketplace with real comprehension checks and retention mechanics.

Course creation

- "Other" category option with a free-text "please specify" field.
- Paid vs. Subscription pricing model, chosen per course.
- Upload-or-paste-URL choice for both lesson videos and lesson PDFs.
- Per-lesson multiple-choice test authoring (unlimited questions per lesson).
- A submission disclaimer warning the course can't be edited once approved.
- Courses are now genuinely locked from editing once published (previously, re-saving a live course silently reset it to "pending" and quietly lost its commission rate — this is fixed).

Admin review

- Full description always visible (previously only shown in one of two admin views).
- A clickable preview of every lesson's video/material, for both uploaded files and pasted links.

Student learning experience

- A genuinely public Intro video, watchable with no login and no purchase.
- Real "Buy Now" / "Subscribe" actions in place of the old single "Enrol for free" button.
- Sequential lesson unlocking (previously every lesson unlocked at once for any enrolled student).
- Real video-completion detection, instead of marking a lesson "complete" the instant it was opened.
- Per-lesson multiple-choice tests that must be passed (100%) to advance, with a rewatch-and-retry path on failure.

Subscription

- A new **/subscription** page describing the Rs. 100/month plan and listing every course currently included in it.
- A working Subscribe action that unlocks every subscription-tagged course immediately.

Gamification

- XP for watching a lesson video, XP for passing its test, and a bonus for finishing the whole course.
- A Level system with clear XP thresholds (100 / 300 / 500 / 700 XP, and so on).
- Automatically-awarded badges named after the course's category and level, collected on the student's Profile.
- A new **/leaderboard** page with separate Students and Instructors tabs, both resetting weekly — students ranked by Level → badge tier → badge count; instructors ranked by new students enrolled that week.

Bug fixes found and fixed along the way

- Progress tracking was previously shared across whatever account was logged into a browser (not tied to a specific student) — it is now correctly tracked per student.
- My Learning, Certificates, and Profile were reading an older progress format and would have shown a freshly-completed course as 0% — all three now read the corrected, per-student data.
- Logging in used to generate a brand-new account every time, silently disconnecting a returning instructor or student from their own courses, notifications, and progress. The same email now always resolves to the same account.

5. What Was Already Working Before This Build

For context, this is the foundation the above was built on top of — none of this needed to change:

- The public course catalog: browsing, search, filters, and category pages.
- Course detail pages, curriculum display, instructor bios, reviews layout, and wishlist.
- Sign up / login (including quick demo logins for Student, Instructor and Admin).
- The Instructor Dashboard shell (Overview, My Courses, Create Course, Earnings, Students).
- The Admin Panel shell (Overview, All Courses, Instructors, Pending Approvals, Students, Revenue).
- Per-instructor, per-course commission rates set individually by admin at approval time (rather than one fixed platform-wide %).
- The notification system (approval/rejection messages, now also used for badge alerts).
- The Certificates page and its "Verify a Certificate" lookup tool.
- All marketing pages — About, Instructors, Blog, Careers, Press, Help, Community, Privacy, Terms, Refund, Sitemap.
- The visual design system — Udemy-style dense course cards, a single orange-and-white colour palette across the whole site, and the homepage's promo-banner hero.

6. How It's Built — Honest Notes

Ekam currently runs entirely as a front-end application, with no backend server or database. Everything — accounts, courses, progress, purchases, XP, badges — is stored in the browser itself. This keeps the build fast and cheap to iterate on, but it comes with real trade-offs worth knowing about before this goes in front of real users:

- **Payments are simulated.** "Buy Now" and "Subscribe" unlock access instantly — no real money moves, and no payment gateway (Razorpay, Stripe, etc.) is connected yet. Wiring one up is a separate, well-scoped piece of work.
- **Uploaded files stay on one device.** When an instructor "uploads" a video or PDF, it's stored in that specific browser's local storage — it will not appear if the instructor, admin, or a student opens the site on a different device or browser. Pasting a YouTube/PDF link has no such limitation, since that content lives on someone else's server already. Real file uploads that work everywhere would need a small backend plus cloud storage (e.g. a media bucket).
- **Accounts, progress and purchases are all local to the browser.** There is no shared central database — so, for example, the leaderboard only ever shows accounts that have actually logged into that specific browser. A real multi-user launch needs a real backend and database.

None of this blocks demoing or pitching the platform today — it behaves correctly and consistently for anyone testing it on one device. It simply means that going from "demo" to "real, multi-device product" is a clearly bounded next step: add a backend, a database, and a payment gateway, and the front-end logic described in this document carries over largely as-is.

End of document.